What is a Funnel

and how does it actually work

S O M A M A S T E R M I N D

What We'll Cover Today

01 **The dating analogy**
What a funnel really is

02 **Funnels you've already been in**
Netflix, Sephora, Amy Porterfield, Rising Woman

03 **The 4 stages of buyer psychology**
Why most funnels skip steps

04 **The 6 funnel types**
Which one is right for you

05 **Why funnels fail**
The mindset shift that changes everything

06 **Your funnel map**
Homework before Part 2

F

OPENING

You wouldn't propose on a first date.

What It Is

A funnel is the relationship you build before the ask.

It guides someone from "I've just found you" to "I'm ready to buy" — step by step, in the right order, at the right pace.

You wouldn't propose on a first date. Your business shouldn't ask for a sale before it's earned the trust.

The funnel as relationship

1. **You notice them**
   Awareness — they find you
2. **You start talking**
   Nurture — they get to know you
3. **You go on a date**
   Trust — they experience your value
4. **You commit**
   Conversion — they say yes

THE DEFINITION

A funnel is a designed journey.

From stranger → to buyer → to raving fan.

Top of funnel

AWARENESS

How people find you — social content, reels, referrals, ads. This is where strangers first encounter your world.

Middle of funnel

NURTURE

Lead magnet, email sequence, free training, DM conversation. This is where trust is built and belief in your solution grows.

Bottom of funnel

CONVERSION

Sales page, discovery call, checkout, or direct offer. This is where she becomes a paying client — and the back-end begins.

Most businesses only operate at the top. The nurture gap is where revenue leaks.

FUNNELS YOU'VE ALREADY BEEN IN

You've been in these funnels. You just didn't see the mechanics.

Netflix

FREE TRIAL FUNNEL

Ad → Free trial → Email + card → Subscriber for life

Value before ask. Let her experience it before she commits.

Sephora

LOYALTY + UPSELL FUNNEL

Browse → Beauty Insider sign-up → Points & gifts → Repeat buyer

The value ladder in action. Move her from first purchase to lifetime client.

Amy Porterfield

FREE MASTERCLASS FUNNEL

Podcast/Instagram → Free training opt-in → Email nurture → Course offer

Walks buyers through all four awareness stages. Never skips a step.

Rising Woman

QUIZ FUNNEL

Instagram story/ad/post → Quiz → Result + VSL → $99 offer

Interactive + personal = 50–60% opt-in rates. Low-ticket offer at the end converts warm leads fast.

Attention (Top): *Grab eyeballs — hook them with headlines, ads, or problems they relate to.*

Interest: *Spark curiosity — give value, tell stories, show benefits.*

Decision (or Desire): *Build emotional want — testimonials, comparisons, proof they need it.*

Action (Bottom): *Make it easy to buy — clear CTA, limited offers, no friction.*

SIMPLE SALES FUNNEL ROADMAP

Your Simple Funnel for SOMA Mastermind – Rising Woman

The 4 stages every buyer moves through.

Most funnels jump to 'buy now.' Successful ones walk people through every stage first.

01

Problem aware

She knows something is wrong but hasn't named it yet.

Speak to her pain in your content — not your solution.

02

Solution aware

She knows solutions exist but hasn't found the right fit.

Your lead magnet positions your approach as the answer.

03

Product aware

She knows you exist. She's reading your emails, watching your stories.

Nurture with testimonials, value, and objection-handling.

04

Most aware

She knows, likes, and trusts you. She needs a clear next step.

Make the offer obvious, easy, and low-risk.

FUNNEL TYPES

There is no one-size funnel. Choose based on your offer, audience, and stage.

Start here

Free opt-in

Lead magnet → landing page → welcome sequence. The foundation of every list.

Stage 2

$27–$97

Tripwire

Low-ticket offer on the thank-you page. Converts subscribers into buyers immediately.

Stage 2–3

Best for $297+

Webinar / Workshop

Live or recorded training that delivers value and ends with an offer. Highest-converting for mid-ticket.

Stage 3

50–60% opt-in

Quiz funnel

Interactive, personalised entry point. Segments your list and delivers tailored sequences.

Stage 2–3

High-ticket $2k+

Application

Filters and qualifies buyers before a discovery call. Best for premium coaching offers.

Stage 3–4

Instagram

ManyChat / DM

Automated DM funnel triggered by post comments. Captures leads without leaving the platform.

Stage 1–2

It's rarely the landing page.

01

Wrong offer or wrong audience

No optimisation fixes a mismatched offer. If 300+ clicks produce zero sales, revisit the offer before touching the page.

02

Skipping buyer psychology stages

Sending cold traffic straight to a sales page rarely works. People need to move through trust-building steps first.

03

Copying templates without understanding the principles

A funnel built for someone else's audience and voice won't work for yours. Learn the why, then customise everything.

04

No testing, no data, no iteration

Most people launch once, see low conversions, and quit. Every launch is an experiment — low numbers are data, not failure.

FUNNEL BENCHMARKS

Funnels are math + psychology + iteration.

Know your numbers. Find the weakest link. Optimise that one thing first.

2%+

Click-through rate

on ads

20–30%

Landing page

conversion rate

10–20%

Add-to-cart

rate

2–5%

Sales conversion

cold traffic

5–10%

Sales conversion

warm traffic

20–30%

Order bump

uptake rate

Map Your Funnel

15 minutes. Paper.

1

Draw your funnel

Every step from how someone finds you to how they pay you. Be honest about the gaps.

2

Identify your stage

Which buyer psychology stage does your current content speak to?

3

Name your biggest gap

Bring it to Part 2. This is your starting point.

In Part 2: choosing your entry point, building your lead magnet, setting up your email sequence, and connecting all the pieces.

Breakout Conversation

In your small group, share:

What do you do? How does someone find you? What's the first step in your customer journey? What's the step after that? What is your end goal for a custom journey?